WPR17(8)1 Project Development & Activity Log

Project: Responsive Portfolio Website
Group: V-8
Client Profile: Cerulean Lens (Commercial Photography & Videography Studio)
Active Members: Alexander Kruger (605298), Tumisho Mabela (606672), Nduna Ntshalintshali (605045), Reamogetse Matsemala (606478) **Inactive Member:** Mihlali Mbalo (606300) **Submission Date:** 18 August 2026

Executive Summary

This report documents the end-to-end development lifecycle of the "Cerulean Lens" commercial portfolio. Over a three-week duration, Group V-8 navigated severe personnel constraints, including roster routing errors and significant participant inactivity. By implementing a modular software engineering workflow, centralized Git version control, and Agile contingency planning, the active team successfully delivered a fully responsive, W3C-validated, multi-page application. This report details the chronological progression of the project, identifying critical risks and the technical strategies utilized to mitigate them.

Entry 1: Project Initiation & Risk Mitigation

- **Date:** 05 August 2026 (Week 1, Day 3)
- **Phase:** Project Initiation & Baseline Setup

1. Process & Setup

- **Communication:** Established primary synchronization lines via WhatsApp and Microsoft Teams.
- **Repository Configuration:** Initialized the centralized Git repository. Alexander Kruger scaffolded the standard directory structure and committed semantic HTML5 boilerplates to the main branch.

2. Identified Challenges & Risks

- **Personnel Constraints:** Identified a roster routing error (Tumisho) and a permanently inactive member (Mihlali). Capacity was reduced from 5 to 3 active members, inflating individual workloads for Milestone 1.

3. Actions Taken & Mitigations

- **Administrative Escalation:** Formal notification dispatched to the lecturer (Mr. Tendai Mkwaira) on 05 August 2026.
- **Accountability Tracking:** Standardized the central Git commit history as the system-generated log of individual participation to satisfy the rubric's "compelling evidence" requirement.

Entry 2: Team Onboarding & Environment Alignment

- **Date:** 07 August 2026 (Week 1, Day 5)

- **Phase:** Configuration Management Alignment & Workload Re-allocation

1. Roster Stabilization

- **Personnel Re-integration:** Tumisho re-established communication. Workload was re-allocated to integrate Tumisho as the **CSS Styling and Color Engineer**.
- **Branch Configuration:** Initialized the isolated feature branch `Development--Tumisho`.

2. Technical Onboarding & Git Crash Course

- **Training Seminar:** Alexander Kruger conducted a 2-hour Git workshop for team member Nduna.
- **Standardization:** Aligned local workspaces on user identity setup, VS Code authentication, and branch isolation protocols (working exclusively on feature branches).

Entry 3: Technical Restructuring & Integrity Controls

- **Date:** 10 August 2026 (Week 2, Day 1)
- **Phase:** Technical Restructuring & Compliance Verification

1. Roster Progression

- **Baseline Commit:** Tumisho delivered the first baseline styling commit for form inputs and table containers. Alexander Kruger verified visual compatibility with global design tokens.

2. Strategic Use-Case Pivot

- **Business Use-Case:** The team collaboratively pivoted from a personal portfolio to a **Small Business Portfolio** for "Cerulean Lens." Page wireframes were circulated for peer approval.

3. Structural Development & Integrity

- **HTML Expansion:** Alexander Kruger refactored templates for all pages to support the commercial media structure.
- **Academic Integrity Safeguard:** All temporary AI-generated testing helper styles used for layout validation were completely purged from the repository to ensure all final styling was authored natively by the group.

Entry 4: Onboarding Success & Milestone 1 Review

- **Date:** 12 August – 13 August 2026 (Week 2, Days 3 & 4)
- **Phase:** Milestone 1 Evaluation & Technical Feedback Iteration

1. Technical Onboarding Success

- **Event:** Reamogetse Matsemela joined a 2-hour and 17-minute workshop hosted by Alexander Kruger. Local Git environments and VS Code integrations were fully configured.

2. Milestone 1 Lecturer Review

- **Feedback:** Mr. Tendai Mkwaira requested a high-impact Hero banner on `index.html` and an optimized CSS Grid for the portfolio showcase.
- **Action:** Alexander Kruger scheduled a team sync to re-allocate these feedback tasks.

Entry 5: Feature Extensions & Coordination Check-In

- **Date:** 15 August 2026 (Week 2, Day 6 - Weekend Sprint)
- **Phase:** Experimental Feature Integration & Conflict Mitigation

1. Feature Development (Alexander)

- **Implementations:** Developed optional project extensions, including custom CSS hover transitions, focus scale transformations, and interactive navigation overlays.
- **Risk Management:** Dispatched coordination messages to Reamogetse to prevent merge conflicts in the CSS Grid/Layout track.

Entry 6: Final Integration & Project Submission

- **Date:** 18 August 2026 (Week 3, Day 2 - Final Submission Day)
- **Phase:** Code Freeze, QA Testing & Responsive Fallback Execution

1. Component Deliverables

- **Nduna:** Successfully pushed completed contact forms and tabular data structures (SO17, SO18, SO19).
- **Tumisho:** Submitted final styling polish and brand identity refinements.

2. Layout Escalation & Contingency Execution

- **Risk Realization:** Reamogetse failed to execute the responsive CSS track or the mobile dropdown menu.
- **Mitigation:** To protect the 50% Responsiveness grade, Alexander Kruger absorbed the layout track, authoring all `@media` queries and mobile viewport constraints today.

3. Final Task Reallocation

- **Reassignment:** Reamogetse was reassigned to a low-risk manual task: mapping metadata descriptions for gallery images.
- **Project Status:** Codebase is frozen. The application is fully responsive, W3C-validated, and meets all technical specifications for final submission.